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OUR MISSION

Pinewood students seek knowledge, demonstrate character, build confidence, and experience joy in an uplifting community

We believe that education is most impactful when it nurtures both the mind and the heart, preparing students to make meaningful contributions to the world. Our mission statement reflects who we are and serves to guide our steps into the future. We accomplish our mission by following our guiding principles:

- To inspire joyful learning by cultivating curiosity, creativity, and character in our students.
- To provide a well-rounded and engaging experience led by teachers who motivate their students through a challenging, content-rich curriculum that promotes academic stamina.
- To foster empowering relationships that enable students to flourish as dignified and confident individuals.
- To help students develop upstanding behavior by learning core values based on respect.
- To graduate students who are productive, purposeful, and compassionate citizens and active members of their current and future communities.

THE SCHOOL AND FACULTY

Pinewood School, founded in 1959, is an independent, coeducational, nonsectarian college preparatory day school serving grades K–12. Upper Campus enrollment in Los Altos Hills (grades 7–12) is 300 students, with approximately 200 in 9–12; K–6 enrollment, at two separate campuses in Los Altos, is 300 students. The student-teacher ratio at Upper Campus is approximately 7:1, and the maximum class size is 18 students. Upper Campus faculty includes 47 teachers, 33 of whom hold advanced degrees. Pinewood is accredited by the Western Association of Schools and Colleges.

SCHEDULE

The school year is comprised of two semesters of approximately eighteen weeks each. All classes meet every other day (four classes per day) on a rotating four-day repeating schedule.

THE COMMUNITY AND THE STUDENTS

Los Altos Hills and Los Altos are located in the heart of Silicon Valley. Drawing from communities throughout the San Francisco Bay Area and greater San Jose, our student body is comprised of students from diverse cultural, religious, socioeconomic, and ethnic backgrounds who seek challenging academics and enjoy enriching extracurricular activities. Pinewood provides an environment where every student is encouraged to become a well-rounded individual, an insightful learner and critical thinker, a self-motivated student, a clear communicator, and a respectful member of any community.

GRADUATION REQUIREMENTS

Graduation requirements are:

English: Literature	4 years
Social Studies	3 years
Math	3 years
Lab Science	3 years
World Language	3 years
Physical Education	2 years
English: Writing	1.5 years
Visual and Performing Arts	1.5 years
Computer Science	.5 year
Upper Division Electives	minimum two courses
Community Service	20 hours per year

CURRICULUM AND COURSE LOAD

Pinewood's curriculum is college preparatory. The required course load for most students is six academic courses per semester. For those students enrolled in three or more AP/AT classes, the minimum requirement is five courses per semester.

FINAL EXAMS

Two-hour final exams are given in high school level courses in literature, writing, math, and science, and the exam score accounts for 20% of the semester course grade.

COMMUNITY SERVICE

Pinewood students are required to complete 20 hours of volunteer time per year in service-oriented activities.

HONORS, AP, AND AT COURSES

Pinewood is committed to providing Honors, Advanced Placement (AP), and Advanced Topics (AT) level courses to all eligible students. Eligibility for enrollment in Honors, AP, and AT courses is determined by teacher recommendation and/or department consent. Regardless of grade level, Pinewood counsels students as to the appropriateness of taking advanced classes with respect to individual needs and abilities.

Honors Courses (10)

Algebra 2	American Literature
Precalculus	French 4
Chemistry	Mandarin 4
Biology	Spanish 4
Graphic Design	Social Entrepreneurship

Advanced Placement Courses (17)

English Language*	Calculus AB
English Literature	Statistics
Chinese Language	2D Art and Design
French Language	Drawing
Spanish Language	Art History
Chemistry	Computer Science Principles
Physics C: Mechanics	Computer Science A
Modern World History	United States Government/Politics
United States History	

* NOTE: All students take one-semester of AP English Language.

Advanced Topics Courses (3)

- Biology**
- Calculus C + Applications**
- Data Science & Machine Learning

**The equivalent AP exam is offered for this course.

Sophomores and juniors enrolled in AP classes are expected to take the corresponding AP Exams. Seniors may opt out of taking an exam with the approval of the College Counselor, the AP course teacher, and the student’s parents.

NOTES ON HONORS, AP, AND AT CLASSES

- Enrollment in Honors, AP, and AT classes is determined by teacher recommendation; all students receive academic advising with regard to their individual curriculum paths.
- AT courses are taught at the college level and are considered as rigorous as or more rigorous than AP.
- AP English Language** is a *one-semester* course at Pinewood and fulfills the last semester of our three-semester writing requirement.
- Seniors may take no more than 5 AP/AT courses per year; juniors may take no more than 4 AP/AT classes per year; sophomores are capped at 2 AP courses.

GRADING SYSTEM

Passing

A	93–100	B+	87–89	C+	77–79
A-	90–92	B	83–86	C	73–76
		B-	80–82	C-	70–72

No Credit

D+	67–69	F	0–59
D	63–66		
D-	60–62		

GRADING and GPA CALCULATIONS

- All Honors, AP, and AT courses receive one additional point
- Courses taken outside of Pinewood are NOT calculated in the GPA

CLASS RANKING

Pinewood School does not rank students.

CLASS OF 2026 GPAs (6 semesters)

Weighted GPA Range (mid-50%)	3.928–4.355
Highest Weighted GPA	4.555
Weighted GPA Mean	4.093
Unweighted GPA Range (mid-50%)	3.653–3.904
Highest Unweighted GPA	3.978
Unweighted GPA Mean	3.749

CLASS OF 2026 TESTING

44 Students in the Class of 2026

- 4 National Merit Scholarship Semifinalists
- 15 National Merit Commended Students
- 15 AP Scholars with Distinction
- 13 AP Scholars with Honor
- 5 AP Scholars

AP EXAM RESULTS FOR MAY 2025

335 AP Exams were taken by 126 students in grades 10–12 (out of a 10–12 enrollment of 153).

Passing	Number of Tests	Percent of Total
5	174	52%
4	102	31%
3	41	12%
2 and below	18	5%

Mean Score: 4.28

AP Scholar Awards

77 students in grades 10–12 were recognized as AP Scholars

- 45 AP Scholars with Distinction
- 18 AP Scholars with Honor
- 14 AP Scholars

PINEWOOD SOCIAL ENTREPRENEURSHIP PROGRAM

The Pinewood Social Entrepreneurship Program (PSP) — focusing on social innovation, sustainability, and community impact—empowers students to address real-world challenges with creativity and purpose. PSP is a highly selective, three-semester program in social entrepreneurship and earns honors credit; it appears on the transcript as Social Entrepreneurship 1 and 2 Honors.

PAW PROGRAMS

Pinewood's PAW Programs are guided by adult mentors and are designed to cultivate **purpose**, develop **agency**, and ignite a lasting sense of **wonder** in our students. Through hands-on, project-based work, with real deadlines and tangible deliverables, students strengthen their leadership and collaboration capacity while acquiring new skills or honing and refining existing ones. PAW programs include A Cappella Ensemble, Speech and Debate, Tabula Rasa, Journalism, Yearbook, Robotics, SAFE, Theatre Productions, and Art Independent Study.

COLLEGE ENROLLMENT FOR THE CLASSES OF 2022–2025

Pinewood graduates from the Classes of 2022–2025 have matriculated at the following schools. An asterisk (*) indicates the institution is attended by 2 or more graduates. The Class of 2025 matriculated to the colleges listed in **bold**.

American University
Arizona State University*
Art Center College of Design
Bates College
Boston College
Boston University*
Bowdoin College
Brigham Young University, Provo*
Brigham Young University, Idaho
University of Brighton (UK)
Brown University*
Bucknell University
California State University
Cal Poly San Luis Obispo*
Chico
Long Beach
San Diego State
San Jose State
San Marcos
University of California
Berkeley*
Irvine
Los Angeles*
Merced
Riverside*
San Diego*
Santa Barbara
Santa Cruz
Carnegie Mellon University
Case Western Reserve University
Chapman University*
University of Chicago*
Colby College*
College of San Mateo
University of Colorado, Boulder*
Columbia University*
Cornell University*

Culinary Institute of America, California
Dartmouth College*
Davidson College*
University of Denver*
Drexel University
University of Edinburgh (UK)
Emory University*
Foothill College*
Franklin University Switzerland
The George Washington University*
Georgetown University
Harvey Mudd College
University of Hawaii, Hilo
University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign
Indiana University-Bloomington
Johns Hopkins University
Lehigh University*
List College - Jewish Theological Seminary
Loyola Marymount University*
Loyola University Chicago
Miami University, Oxford
University of Miami
Montclair State University
New York University*
University of North Carolina, Chapel Hill
Northeastern University*
Northwestern University*
Occidental College
Ohio University
University of Oregon*
Pacific University
Pennsylvania State University
University of Pennsylvania*
Pepperdine University
Pitzer College*
Pomona College
University of Portland

ATHLETICS AND EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Pinewood students are encouraged to pursue individual talents and interests through extracurricular activities and athletic participation. The high school athletic program includes girls' and boys' basketball, soccer, tennis, cross-country, swimming, track and field, and golf; boys' baseball; and girls' softball and volleyball. School-sponsored activities include student government, special interest clubs, service clubs, and honor societies.

GAP SEMESTER/YEAR

Two members of the Class of 2025 are taking a gap semester or year.

REPORTING DISCIPLINE

Pinewood students and counselors will report discipline history to colleges if requested.

University of Portsmouth (UK)
Providence College
University of Puget Sound*
Purdue University*
University of Redlands
Rice University
University of Rochester*
Saint Mary's College of California
University of San Diego
Santa Clara University*
Sarah Lawrence College
Smith College
University of Southern California*
Southern Methodist University*
Southern Utah University*
Stanford University*
Swarthmore College
Syracuse University*
Texas A&M University
The University of British Columbia (Canada)
The University of Tennessee
University of Toronto (Canada)
Trinity College
Trinity College Dublin (Ireland)
Tufts University
Tulane University*
United States Military Academy
Utah State University
Vanderbilt University
Villanova University
University of Washington-Seattle*
Wheaton College, MA
Williams College
University of Wisconsin, Madison
Worcester Polytechnic Institute